

α



β

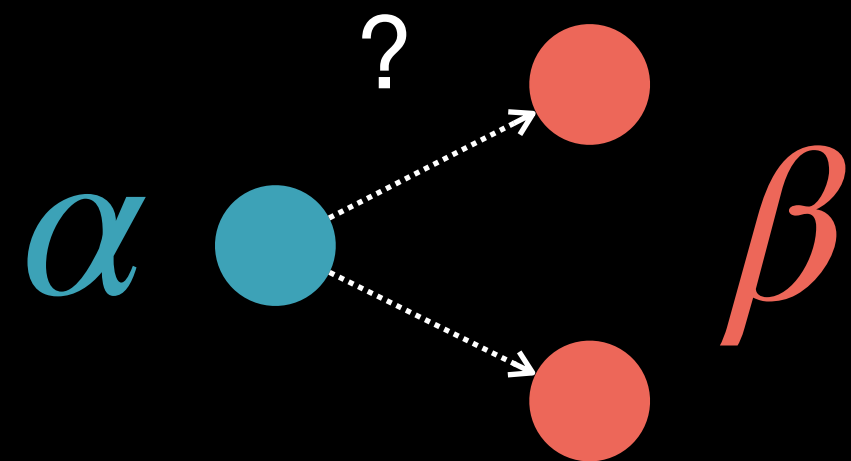




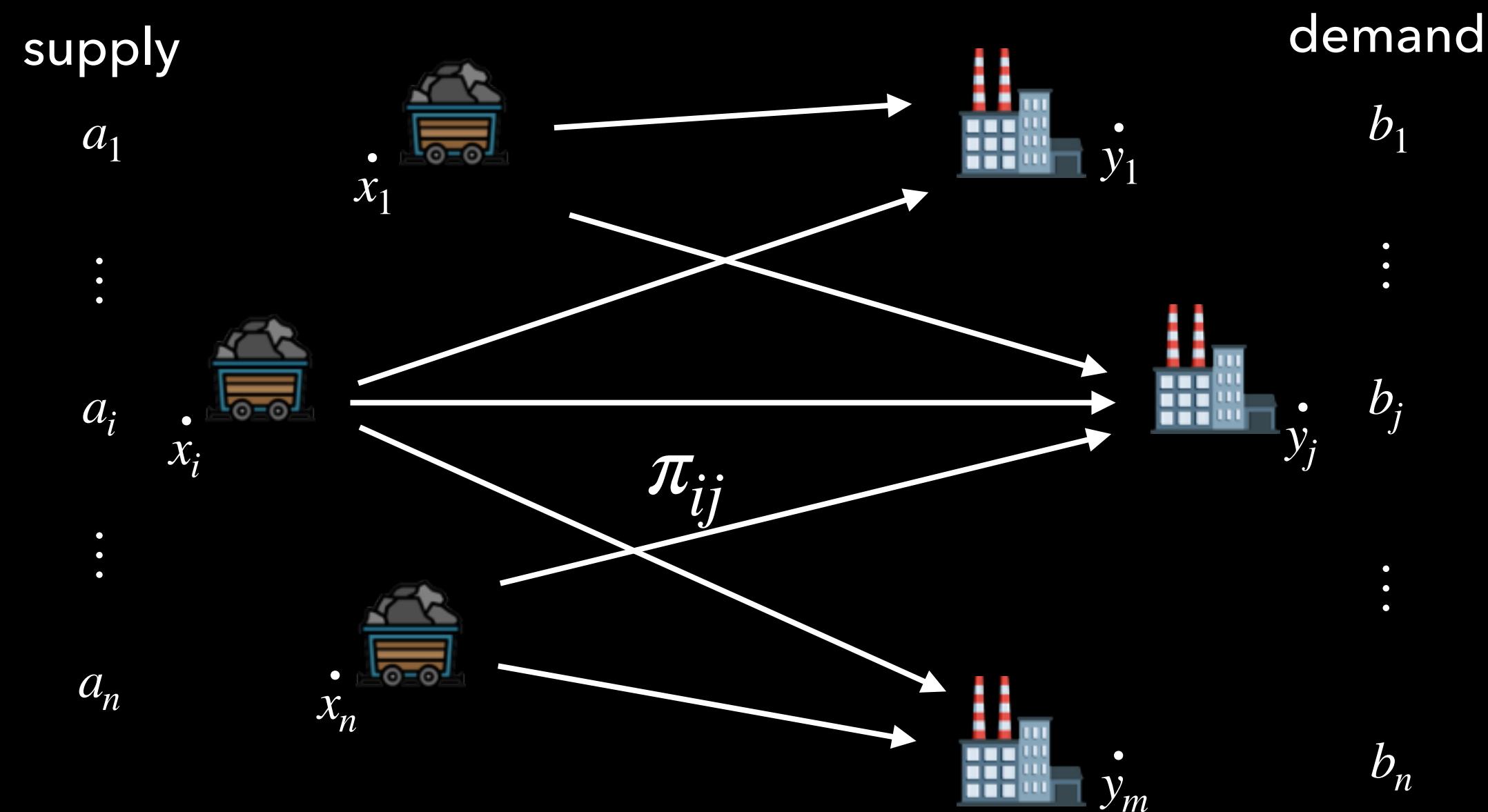




Splitting the Mass



$$a_i \neq b_j??$$



Monge: match i to j (~~~send all the mass in i to j~~)

Kantorovich: send π_{ij} mass from i to j

We call the matrix $[\pi_{ij}]_{i,j=1}^{n,m}$ a **coupling** between **a** and **b**



Couplings Formalize “Splitting”

Prob. measures:

$$\alpha = \sum_1^n \mathbf{a}_i \delta_{x_i}, \mathbf{a} \in \Delta_n,$$

$$\beta = \sum_1^m \mathbf{b}_j \delta_{y_j}, \mathbf{b} \in \Delta_m$$